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DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The UAE has entered the world's 25 most innovative economies for the first time, climbing five places in the 2026 Global Innovation Index as investment in technology, research and entrepreneurship strengthens its position in the global knowledge economy.

The UAE ranked 25th among 139 economies in the index compiled by the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO), up from 30th in 2025.

The country ranked first globally in four indicators: entrepreneurship policies and culture, attracting international students, financing for start-ups and scale-ups, and new investment in research and development and advanced technologies.

The annual index measures innovation performance across 139 economies. Its 2026 edition focuses on enabling entrepreneurs in advanced science and technology to turn scientific discoveries into scalable businesses with broad economic impact, particularly in artificial intelligence, biotechnology, advanced materials, semiconductors and clean energy. It also assesses how innovation ecosystems are evolving amid global economic shifts, uneven growth and challenges facing venture capital markets.

Significant progress

Abdulla Bin Touq Al Marri, Minister of Economy and Tourism, said the country had made significant progress in creating a business environment that encourages innovation and strengthens the competitiveness of the national economy. He said the five-place rise reflected the UAE's institutional, human and technological capabilities and its continued investment in knowledge and technology.

The improvement also demonstrated the country's ability to translate investment and inno-

UAE AMONG 25 MOST INNOVATIVE ECONOMIES

Nation up five places, ranks 1st globally in four innovation indicators



vation capabilities into tangible economic and knowledge-based outcomes, supporting its ambition to become a global centre for the new economy and innovation-driven sectors under the We the UAE 2031 vision, he added.

The UAE also posted strong results across measures of creative and technological output and knowledge diffusion. It ranked sixth globally for the value of brands represented among the world's 5,000 biggest brands,

seventh for mobile application creation, ninth for creative goods exports, 13th for high-tech exports and 19th for intellectual property receipts as a share of total trade. The combined value of UAE brands included among the world's top 5,000 reached about \$101.66 billion in 2026, an increase of 15 per cent from 2025.

Applications produced by UAE-based developers and companies recorded about 2.91 billion downloads worldwide in 2025,

up 9.81 per cent from 2024. The value of the UAE's high-tech exports reached about \$68.05 billion in 2024, an increase of 36.35 per cent from the previous year.

Among world's top 8

The UAE placed among the world's top eight economies in six subcategories. It ranked first in higher education, second in the business environment, fifth in both general infrastructure and knowledge absorption, seventh

in information and communications technology and eighth in credit. Its ranking for innovation inputs improved to 12th globally from 14th in 2025, while its innovation-output ranking advanced five places.

Across the index's seven main pillars, the UAE ranked ninth for institutions, 13th for human capital and research, 13th for infrastructure, 14th for market sophistication and 25th for business sophistication.

Gulf oil exports above pre-war levels

DUBAI
BY STACY PEREIRA
Business Reporter

According to shipping data from maritime intelligence firm Kpler, Middle East crude oil exports rose above pre-war levels on several days in the last few weeks of September, despite continued attacks on commercial vessels around the Strait of Hormuz during those weeks.

Crude exports from the region reached between 19.5 million and 22.5 million barrels per day (bpd) on September 24 and on September 27-29, according to provisional Kpler data cited by Reuters. The seven-day moving average stood at 18.5 million bpd on October 1, above the pre-war average of about 18 million bpd. The increase marks a significant recovery from the sharp disruption to Gulf oil shipments following the start of the US-Israeli war with Iran in late February.

Kpler's own latest analysis provides further detail on how the region has restored oil flows despite continued disruption to its traditional export routes. The firm's analysis, published in early October, found that at least 16.5 million bpd of crude and condensate left the Middle East Gulf region between September 1 and September 28, matching the pre-war average when Iran is excluded. That was 10.5 million bpd higher than the March monthly average, which shows the scale of recovery.

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UAE schools ban parents from taking, sharing photos

Warning against sharing photos without consent

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

Schools in Dubai and Sharjah have issued fresh circulars asking parents and visitors not to take photographs or videos on school premises.

They are also being told not to share pictures or clips showing other students on WhatsApp groups, social media or other digital platforms without appropriate consent, according to school circulars shared with Gulf News by parents.

GEMS Our Own English High School, Sharjah –

Boys, addressed the issue in a circular under the subject "Protecting Our Students' Privacy". Principal and CEO Srivalsan Murugan said the safety, privacy and wellbeing of every child remain the school's highest priority.

GEMS Winchester School – Dubai has issued a circular carrying the same message, signed by CEO and Executive Principal Matthew James Lecuyer.

The International School of Choueifat – Sharjah has taken a firmer line. Its administration said it had come to the school's attention that some parents were taking photos and videos on campus.

The school reminded parents that taking photos or videos on regular school days is strictly prohibited.

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ABU DHABI

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